VIGINTI

The show.
The ship.

Two reasons to keep playing.

One game invites you to wonder what happens when the performance ends. The other makes a long, empty journey feel a little less empty.

FICTION-LED DEVELOPMENT / 17 OCTOBER 2026

Four generated visual targets with proposed asset, rendering and animation workflows. No application code was changed.





The fiction should explain the loop.

The card game remains the centre. These wrappers give ordinary game events a place, a host and an emotional meaning.

GAME ELEMENT	VIGINTI LIVE!	THE LONG COAST
Why this table?	You volunteered for a TV prize; the production will not clearly end the appearance.	You and the onboard AI are passing an exceptionally dull deep-space transit.
Why three hands?	One contestant runs the show's three-hand console.	The AI invented a variant to make the pastime more interesting.
Cash / ante	Your bankroll buys continued participation; insolvency means elimination.	Pretend recreation credits give the two of you a rivalry and a record to beat.
Six relics	Cheap sponsor prizes, suspiciously overpresented.	Magnetic toys and keepsakes turned into game pieces.
Free pack choice	A sponsored commercial-break prize selection.	Three diversions the AI has prepared from the recreation archive.
A failed run	A beaming send-off whose consequences stay off camera.	A loss, a score strip, a dry remark and an ordinary fresh-run offer.
The larger question	Who is keeping this show alive, and what happens to its contestants?	What does this routine mean to the only other mind aboard?

Working fiction, not a proposed rules rewrite. Scoring still targets 21; packs remain free.



GENERATED CONCEPT FRAME / VISUAL TARGET, NOT IMPLEMENTED GAMEPLAY

Viginti Live! / The contestant contract

A cheerful show with a credible immediate motive, and an increasingly evasive answer to what happens when you lose.

THE IMMEDIATE PREMISE

You remember applying to be on television. You remember the promise of prize money. You do not remember agreeing to this many episodes. You are tonight's only contestant, playing all three hands at one enormous console. The host is delighted to have you. The host is always delighted.

WHY KEEP PLAYING?

At first: win money, beat the dealer and enjoy the ludicrous show. Once the seams begin to show: stay solvent long enough to understand the production. Keeping the current cash/ante loop earns your place in the contestant chair. The host says a player who cannot pay the next ante is eliminated, but always answers practical follow-up questions with a cheerful transition.

WHAT LOSING MEANS

A failed run earns a lavish thank-you, a fanfare and an instruction to remain seated. The feed cuts before showing where an eliminated contestant goes. A new run returns to the familiar chair. This supports the present retry loop without committing to death, a supernatural afterlife or a simulation. If a larger story is built, the fate of eliminated contestants deserves a real answer.

THE HOST

Keep the smiling sunburst as a working mascot, not a locked character design. A painted cardboard face that keeps smiling after the performance stops can be more effective than an expensive monster. A hidden producer voice offers occasional corrections through a speaker. Their relationship can supply warmth, incompetence and tension without a large cast.

THREE LAYERS OF DISCOVERY

1. A playable, funny card show with silly prizes.
2. A functioning production whose cues behave incorrectly: the same cough in every applause track, a sponsor wrapper with no sponsor, a host insisting every appearance is your first.
3. A personal question: are you still a guest, or have you become part of the machinery that keeps the show alive?

ONE SUGGESTIVE CONTRADICTION AT A TIME

The audience seats are empty, but the applause is lively. The decorative lights stop, but the camera tally remains red. The APPLAUSE lamp stays on while everybody is silent. These should be occasional authored cues attached to ordinary play, never a continuous collection of haunted props. Let players notice the mismatch before anyone explains it.

KEEP THE TRUTH OPEN, NOT THE SITUATION

We can postpone deciding whether the network is coercive, abandoned, automated or something stranger. We should not postpone the basic contract: you came for a prize, the show controls elimination, and you want to know what happens next. This is a stronger foundation than starting with an unexplained room and assuming atmosphere alone will provide motivation.

WHY THE WRONG LATIN SURVIVES

The network commissioned twenty bulbs for a game about twenty-one. Someone taped on a +1. The announcer still pronounces VIGINTI with ludicrous authority. It is a production mistake everyone has built their work around, not a new mathematical rule or a puzzle the player has to solve.

Viginti Live! / Make the room perform

Bright spectacle and unsettling silence can use the same assets. Timing is as important as texture.

ASSETS

A single console, modular plywood flats, one camera silhouette, a little audience riser and a cutout host. Build a small reusable family of absurd prize trophies. Use authored vector graphics for cards, signs, prize labels and sponsor wrappers; rasterize into controlled atlases. Model only visible mechanical depth. Keep rough cardboard backs, tape and stage braces at the edges.

THREE.JS RECIPE

Start with MeshToonMaterial and a nearest-sampled three-band gradient. Add chosen silhouette outlines with inverted hulls or an outline pass. Halftone belongs in selected shadow bands, not over every surface. Use warm spotlights for the performance and a separate cold backstage light. Composite bloom from marquee lamps and indicators only; cream cards and typography remain clear.

A REUSABLE PERFORMANCE STATE

One event-driven production controller selects: on-air, commercial break, payout, or between-takes. It coordinates marquee intensity, host hinge pose, camera tally, applause and music. The card game remains authoritative. These states are proposed presentation work, not new betting rules. A hidden producer can be a short bank of authored lines; no live dialogue service is necessary.

JUICE WITH A JOB

Hover lifts a card and tilts its corner. Pressing DRAW compresses a large key before the shoe flicks a card out. Placement gets a short spring and a papery clap. Scoring rows illuminate their own bay. A completed payout earns a room-wide bulb chase, one musical sting and a bounded burst of instanced paper stars. All large effects follow the result, not every arithmetic step.

PACKS ARE THE COMMERCIAL BREAK

The current three free choices arrive as sponsor parcels on spring-loaded prize trays: Raise, Deck and Relic. Selecting one opens the familiar card choices. Sponsor language and wrapper design can become stranger over successive ante increases. The packs are still free and the contents still come from the existing engine.

A 20-SECOND UNSETTLING BEAT

The last score resolves. The theme tune finishes slightly too early. The room waits. The APPLAUSE light comes on, but no applause follows. The host folds its gloves without losing the printed grin. A backstage work light reveals the backs of the flats. A monitor says PLEASE REMAIN SEATED. The camera remains live. Then one bright button offers another run.

PRODUCTION RISK

It is easy to make a generic sinister mascot show. The identity should come from television grammar: cues, editing, performer fatigue, sponsor language and the gap between what the viewer sees and what the studio contains. Humour must remain enjoyable on repeated play. A fully voiced branching horror story would multiply the scope; a compact cue vocabulary need not.

The smile has not changed. The room has.



GENERATED CONCEPT FRAME / VISUAL TARGET, NOT IMPLEMENTED GAMEPLAY

02 / THE LONG COAST

Nothing outside. Someone to play with inside.



GENERATED CONCEPT FRAME / VISUAL TARGET, NOT IMPLEMENTED GAMEPLAY

The Long Coast / The shared routine

Deep-space boredom gives the card game a reason to exist. Rivalry and companionship give it a reason to continue.

THE IMMEDIATE PREMISE

You are on an uneventful deep-space transit. The next useful thing is days or weeks away. There is nobody to call in real time, nothing interesting beyond the window, and a finite number of ways to rearrange the galley. The onboard AI offers to play cards. It has invented a variant, confidently named it VIGINTI, and already printed the label.

WHY KEEP PLAYING?

Because the game is fun, the journey is long, and the only other intelligence aboard has become a surprisingly irritating friend. You want to beat its record. It wants to prove its latest rules are good. The emotional stake is a shared ritual: one more hand together. This does not require a hostage plot or a secret catastrophe to justify the table.

WHAT LOSING MEANS

The recreation credits are pretend. When the bankroll runs out, the AI wins the argument for a minute. Starting a fresh run gives you the ordinary fresh-run balance; the ship is not supplying emergency loans during a run. A paper score summary prints, the AI makes one dry remark, and the game offers the next round of rivalry. No need to turn cash into oxygen or fuel.

HOW THE AI EXISTS PHYSICALLY

Its face lives on a small ship terminal, not a giant casino sign. A maintenance gripper handles the deck shoe and occasionally overshoots a card by a few millimetres. Magnetic trinkets sit on the rail. A mug, photo, strap and folded cloth establish that someone has been living beside this table. The whole ship can sound alive without the terminal talking all the time.

A RELATIONSHIP IN SHORT REACTIONS

At first the AI is a literal-minded host. It grows competitive, then starts making little accommodations that it describes as efficiency improvements. It can be smug about a bust and awkward about a genuinely good hand. Its concern is most effective when expressed through the world: quietly raising the task lamp, waiting to deal while you examine a relic, or recalling an old score.

THE NAME BECOMES A SHARED JOKE

When corrected about the Latin, the AI says: "The labels are already printed." Later it might concede: "Twenty was within tolerance." Use the joke sparingly. The title remains wrong because both companions now enjoy the argument, not because the AI cannot do basic blackjack arithmetic.

PACKS ARE SOMETHING IT MADE FOR YOU

Between stretches of play, the AI proposes three new diversions from the recreation archive. Raise, Deck and Relic packs emerge as sealed little printed packets. They are modifications to this intentionally silly pastime, not upgrades to the spacecraft. A relic can look like a spare fuse or a souvenir rocket without affecting propulsion or survival systems.

QUIET DOES NOT MEAN NO STORY

A destination photograph appears beside the monitor. A recorded message arrives after a long delay. The AI remembers which cheap trophy you kept. These are optional authored environmental beats, not assumed new mechanics. The interesting question is what companionship means to this machine. Making it secretly murderous would be a separate direction and would change the appeal of this version.

The Long Coast / Make the ship familiar

The expressive centre is a terminal, a gripper, some paper cards and a small pool of lamplight.

ASSETS

Build one compact low-poly galley nook, one fold-down table, a CRT terminal and a two- or three-joint service gripper. Paint 128-256 pixel atlases with deliberate wear and clear silhouette edges. Keep a small shared junk/toy atlas for relics. Use a separate clean card-face atlas with large rank indices. Photos and paper labels carry personal history cheaply.

THREE.JS RECIPE

Use a 640x360 or 960x540 internal scene target as an initial experiment, then nearest-neighbour upscale. Point-filtered low-resolution textures, scene resolution and geometry are independent style choices. Test nearest mip sampling to control shimmer on the tilted table. Add restrained ordered dithering to gradients, baked light and vertex colour. Avoid vertex jitter on cards and buttons.

LIGHTING AND SPACE

A warm practical lamp gives the table its own island of readability; dim blue cabin fill gives depth. The CRT gets a little emissive glow, not full-screen bloom. Render sparse stars with a background or distant points and very slow orientation drift. A nearly empty window is stronger for this fiction than planet flybys or racing star streaks. Night mode changes the room, not the legibility of the cards.

A SMALLER, MORE PHYSICAL KIND OF JUICE

The shoe rattles, the gripper transfers a card, and the paper flexes before settling. A payout ticks through a cheap mechanical counter and curls a paper score strip. A good hand makes the AI's mouth briefly asymmetrical. Its fan changes pitch while it computes a suitably dignified response. The environment should feel responsive without performing a full light show.

SOUND CARRIES THE DISTANCE

Layer ventilation, tiny relay clicks, a quiet hull hum, the deck motor and papery contact sounds. Let silences sit between lines. Music can come from a little recreation speaker instead of an omnipresent score. The AI's voice should have warmth and limits: a small bank of performed or synthesized authored lines, paired with captions where needed.

A CHARACTER WITHOUT A LIVE AI DEPENDENCY

The fictional onboard AI can be implemented as a deterministic character system keyed to events: first bust, unusual hand, long run, pack choice and idle return. Track a few small relationship flags if desired, then select authored lines and expressions. This keeps the free game playable offline and prevents banter from changing the rules or pacing unpredictably.

PRODUCTION RISK

The empty journey could become visually inert, and familiar retro space hardware could feel generic. Personal objects, physical card handling and the AI's restraint provide identity. Do not fill every quiet moment with chatter or cosmic spectacle. Prototype a whole minute of idle, hover and dealing to check whether the little shared space is pleasant to inhabit.

02 / THE LONG COAST / NIGHT CYCLE

One more hand before the next shift.



GENERATED CONCEPT FRAME / VISUAL TARGET, NOT IMPLEMENTED GAMEPLAY

Build the show first. Keep the ship distinct.

The game show is the recommended lead: it supports immediate fun, larger feedback and a mystery without replacing the card game.

WHY THE SHOW LEADS

Its ordinary actions already resemble television production: dealing is a cue, scoring is a reveal, packs are a commercial break, and a lost run is elimination. The colourful front and raw backstage space can share one set. That gives the Three.js migration a dramatic reason for perspective, depth and lighting changes.

WHAT THE SPACE VERSION DOES BETTER

The ship provides a more natural home for relaxed repeat play and a recurring relationship. Its losing state does not need to be frightening to matter. It is also a useful independent alternative if the television fiction begins demanding more narrative escalation than this game wants.

DO NOT COMBINE THE PITCHES YET

Putting the game show on the ship would blur their clearest emotional differences and add fiction to explain. Prototype each as a complete, small place. Choose on the basis of how it feels to play for several minutes, not which backdrop makes the most dramatic still image.

A REAL DECISION TO MAKE LATER

For the show: what does elimination ultimately mean? For the ship: how much does the AI remember between runs? Those answers affect the writing scope. Neither needs to block a first material-and-motion prototype.

A 45-SECOND SHOW PROTOTYPE

0-8s: idle, hover and a large physical DRAW press.
8-18s: one curved card deal and placement.
18-28s: a relic cue and satisfying payout.
28-35s: the familiar free pack choice as a sponsor break.
35-45s: end-of-run lighting, wrong applause timing and the unchanged host grin.
Use a fixed event sequence for art testing; do not alter ordinary player outcomes.

A 45-SECOND SHIP PROTOTYPE

Replay the same ordinary card sequence with the terminal and gripper. Trade marquee spectacle for a small display reaction, counter ticks and score paper. Include a quiet interval: if the nook feels uncomfortable to sit in without constant action, the material and sound work need another pass.

SHARED IMPLEMENTATION FOUNDATION

Keep the engine, RNG and existing event stream authoritative. The Three.js layer animates those events and sends the same player actions. Subdivided cards need front/back faces, a thin edge, bend-aware normals and matching shadows. Pointer picking and readable ranks must agree with the animated cards. Retain readable semantic controls for detailed information.

WHAT TO VERIFY

Readability at the smallest supported viewport, selection feedback during motion, pacing after repeated wins, and worst-case frame time with all relics. Lighting and postprocessing must preserve gameplay. The images here are visual targets only; there is no measured rendering performance yet.

References, limits and saved materials.

Primary sources reviewed 17 October 2026. The rendering recipes are proposed Three.js work, not claims about other games' implementations.

FICTION / PRESENTATION COMPARISONS

The Crush House - Official description: a colourful television production with sinister secrets. The reference shows that darkly comic TV fiction is established territory; Viginti's specific identity would come from its contestant chair, card ritual and cue-driven set.

Event[0] - Official description: building a relationship with a lonely spaceship computer. This is a relevant neighbouring premise. The proposed ship version centres on routine and competitive companionship rather than adopting that game's story or dialogue mechanics.

Duskers - Official description: old gritty interfaces as the player's eyes and ears in an isolated space setting. Useful for economical atmosphere, not a template for this game's survival mechanics.

CloverPit - Room-scale gambling presentation remains a useful spatial comparison. The ship is now private and in transit, rather than a roadside public casino.

GENERATED FRAMES

Four new images were made with the built-in image generation tool using the earlier game-show and space concept frames as references. These are independent concept studies, not a continuity-locked scene or an implemented animation. Card pips, text and displayed balances are illustrative and require precise final authoring.

OFFICIAL THREE.JS DOCUMENTATION

MeshToonMaterial - Toon shading and nearest-filtered gradient maps.

Texture - Minification, magnification, mip and anisotropy choices.

RenderTarget - Offscreen scene buffers for the ship's internal resolution and postprocessing.

UnrealBloomPass - Bloom controls. Restricting bloom to show lights requires an explicit selection/compositing setup.

InstancedMesh - Repeated geometry with different transforms can reduce draw calls; useful for pooled confetti and counters.

SAVED WITH THIS BRIEF

The four selected PNGs, full prompt set and development notes are in output/art-direction/viginti-show-and-ship. A ZIP contains those files and this PDF. Earlier five-world exploration files remain available separately. No application source, server configuration or game rules were changed.

WHAT IS DELIBERATELY UNRESOLVED

The host's final character design, the reality behind the television production, the eliminated contestants' fate, and the AI's exact history are open creative choices. Immediate motivation and run consequences are developed here; a full branching story is not assumed.